

Step 6: Enter your real name, your username (Ubuntu will automatically make your first name your username, though you can change it), computer's name (useful for a networked setup) and password for the user. Ubuntu will warn you if you choose a weak password. You can still use it. However, it's always good to have a stronger password (more than 8 characters, mixed case, special characters and digits included). You may also choose to automatically log in when the computer starts. Remember the password you enter here. Ubuntu will not offer you the luxury of forgetting it nor will it offer you a 'forgot password' option. Although you can reset your Linux password later by following the trick published in the April 2011 issue of *Digit*, it's always good to remember your password.

Step 7: If you're connected to the internet, it will download the package list so that you're ready to install new software as and when you reboot. If you want, you can stop this process by clicking the 'Skip' button which reveals when you click on the line showing the current status. Oh, and if you'd allow Ubuntu to get the latest list of software, it will (proudly) show you a slideshow of its best features (reminds you of something called 'XP', huh?) by the time.

Step 8: There is no step 8. Ubuntu is installed. Just restart the system!

Step 9: Once again, there is no step 9. Ubuntu won't ask you for any more details after the reboot. Enjoy Ubuntu!

Installing as a dual-boot setup

Man is made of habits. We simply don't want to let go of the old so easily. If you're already using Windows, chances are high that you won't take a plunging leap by removing it and installing Ubuntu on your machine. You want to have the best of both worlds and will finally shift to Ubuntu only when you're satisfied that it will fit your needs. Till that day you'd use Windows and try out Ubuntu only for a change.

Any operating system requires a separate partition to be installed. This is the case because it might need files with the same name and path, and also because file systems might vary for different operating systems. While Ubuntu can read and write on Windows file systems (FAT32 / NTFS), it can't be installed on partitions formatted with any one of them. It's important that Ubuntu receives its own partition.